



Appendix 1: Chakra

Players usually don't need to worry about Chakra; they're simply an example of an in-game reason to limit certain combinations or quantities of powers.

In classic mysticism the seven great chakra are the major life-force nexi of the mind, spirit, and body, the energy centers which power and bind together the entire assembly. Fantasy biologists see them as major neural connections, and thus as primary centers of bioelectrical activity.

In game terms Chakra are balance points for mystic energies; the locations where external sources of power may be safely bound to someone's essence on a permanent basis. Trying to do it elsewhere will create severe imbalances, leading to madness, bizarre physical distortions, or even death. Trying to link two differing sources of power to a single chakra is likely to produce similar results, since they will essentially be short-circuited through the character's mind, body and spirit or forced together on the same wavelength.

In practical terms, this means that there is an upper limit to the number of power sources any one character can tap, and on their types; some chakra are suitable for particular power sources and some are not. This is why, for example, a character can be a either were-wolf or a were-tiger (or any other were-creature) but not both; the relevant chakra can only be linked to a single one of the two totems. The basic seven Chakra are:

Muladhara rests at the base of the spine. It's linked with earth, survival, physical health, prosperity, and strength. This primal chakra, present in every multicellular organism, also relates to shamanistic and "Hoarding" magic. Lycanthropy results when a character is linked to a totem through this chakra.

Svadhithana swirls in the lower abdomen. It's associated with water, emotions, sexuality, growth, Charisma, and transformation, and is tied to the Dragon Path.

Manipura burns in the solar plexus. It's associated with fire, psychic energy, vitality, Constitution, strength of purpose, and action. It fuels Psychic abilities.

Anahata breathes in the heart. Associated with air, balance, relationships, and dexterity, it's the only active chakra in mindless undead, and is linked with Dweomer, Thaumaturgy and Divine Magic.

Visshudha throbs in the throat. It's associated with communication, creativity, manipulation, and self-expression. It's also associated with Mana, and so expresses the bond between magic, names, speech, and language. The psychic aspects of Charisma, as well as

Theurgy and Arcane magic, and the way of the Mystic Artist, are tied to this chakra.

Ajna peers out from the brow. This "third eye" is associated with perception, imagination, illusion, intuition, light, and darkness. The intellect, in both knowledge and ignorance, flows from it, as does Channeling.

Sahasrara bathes everything in light at the crown at the top of the head. Associated with awareness, Wisdom, cosmic consciousness, and the astral plane, this chakra control's the user's Dominion.

Gods, Spirits, and a few epic heroes have two additional Chakra:

Kihadhara. The Celestial Chakra usually drifts just above the head, extending tendrils of light to surround the possessor. A manifestation of a link between the possessor and the abstract realms of the deeper astral, it is associated with spheres of influence, synchronicity, immortality, and the creation of new realms. In traditional theory, full development of Kihadhara offers unity with the cosmic all. It governs the use of Godfire.

Bindhudharma. The Anchoring Chakra floats just below the feet, with its whirls also surrounding the possessor. It's a manifestation of the possessor's bond with the material world, whether through some relic, emotional tie, magical effect, or dedicated worshipers. Associated with manifestation and channeling power to others, it also promotes preservation, order, and stability.

Chakra are usually more or less self-contained; their energies interact with those of other living beings and fuel an entity's personal talents. The seven common chakra are not linked by default to any other source of power.

Once opened, a difficult and sometimes dangerous process, each Chakra can be bonded to or infused with one other source of power over and above the character's personal energy sources. Common power sources include:

Enchanted and Psychically-imbued items. These may be Absorbed (Innate Enchantment), Linked (Mystic Link), or Bonded (symbiotic or parasitic items). Those using Mystic Links can partially get around the "one-power-source-per-chakra" limitation by binding together many items as a single "horde" - but such hordes are tempting targets. Sets of more mundane items linked psychologically or via some minor common charm, are also manageable.

Power-Dimensions and Nexi. Stonehenge, "Elemental Planes," Ley Line Nexi, and sometimes even sources of physical energies fall into this category. It is





wise to have a selection of “channels” ready to direct such forces into. User should beware of overloads when tapping into such near-limitless sources. The typical user will gain a variety of innate talents, but will also suffer from a severe vulnerability to opposing forces.

Runes, Domains, Paths, and Spheres. These resemble Power Dimensions and Nexi at first glance, but have less defined “locations” and, as philosophical entities, are more subject to the user’s will. Overload is not a problem, but the mental effects can be severe. Characters drawing on the same runes will always be at least subliminally in contact, and some foes may be able to use this as a weakness. Divine spheres are even more dangerous; they greatly influence their users. Those who claim a sphere must either rigidly stress their differences, fight constantly, or risk drowning themselves in a common conceptual reality, forgetting where it stops and they begin. Paths and Domains are far more limited and far safer.

Beings, Familiars, and Spirits. In general, these only work smoothly if one of the entities involved is firmly in control of the energy flows. Subsumption - incorporating other spirits into your Chakra - is an easy shortcut to great power, but has severe mental side effects. Pacts allow the user to tap into a portion of the power of some mighty entity, but there’s usually a price. Either the entity will charge for the access in some way, or the character must take great pains to maintain the link. Examples include priestly orders, totem magic or lycanthropy (the distinction depends on who’s in control), and familiars (minor entities which draw extra power from you).

Energy Storage. Opened, but unbonded, Chakra can be used to simply store power, either raw, in the form of Mana, Psi-Energy, spell levels or purely physical energies, or in the far more stable and thus more readily stored and controlled forms of preset effects. In general, the power which can be stored in any single chakra this way is related to its level of development as measured by the related attribute.

Chakra usually hold positive aspects, their energies devoted to growth, expansion, achievement, and the development of life. They can be negatively oriented (although this is rare among playable species) directed towards the destruction of the qualities they normally enhance. If the balance of a character’s chakra runs too strongly towards the negative he or she may come to embody the entropic energies of the universe - falling into undeath or becoming a demon. Similarly, sufficient focus on, and development of, positive aspects can raise a character into the ranks of the celestials or pure spirits.

In theory Chakra should all be developed at the same time, opened in sequence along the spine, and be correctly balanced so as to finally flower into the

Kihadhara and Bhindudharma chakra simultaneously for a harmonious ascension into the higher realms.

Like most other ideal paths of self-development this hardly ever occurs. Unbalanced development can, at least in theory, cause various psychological and even physiological imbalances or ailments. In practice, such effects are generally so mixed with environmental, genetic, and personal factors as to be indistinguishable.

Note that lacking a chakra does not (necessarily) indicate that a creature cannot have any of the related abilities; it simply means that they are either quite weak or not self-generating.

Mindless Plants have only the Muladhara chakra. It’s normally in positive mode, save for fungi and other parasitic species. Certain animals, such as sponges, also fall into this category. While their struggles are slower than those of animals, plants battle with a ruthlessness unheard of in animals. Plants face a constant contest for survival. They know neither rest nor peace, so while their bodies may work without haste, on that scale of time they fight with all their might. Only in a few locations well regulated by higher powers do they grow unmarred.

Sentient plants have the Muladhara, Manipura, and Ajna chakra. They tend to be a bit uninterested in higher forces, somewhat unemotional, and ruthless when dealing with animal creatures - but are less so than their primal relatives. Many recognize concepts such as offspring and have families, though they still care little for the world outside their chosen home.

Nonsentient animals lack the Ajna and Sahasrara chakra. Of course, equipped with effective instincts and senses, they quite arguably have little need of them.

Sentient animals (*i.e.*, people) have all seven of the major chakra, although as always, they may be more or less developed in any given case. Actually developing chakra and their associated powers will usually take a good deal of time, effort, and CP.

Mindless undead have only the Anahata chakra in the negative mode. This is why they tend to attack old friends and kin in preference to other targets when uncontrolled, and are so vulnerable to divine magic.

Sentient undead lack two Chakra, Svadhisthana and Sahasrara. Even at their best, undead tend to be lacking in true wisdom, uncharismatic, and detached. Generally all their chakra will all be in negative modes. Undead have been known to bypass this lack and reach godhood - but this is extremely rare. Most undead gods achieved godhood first, enabling them to retain all chakra regardless of their physical form’s status.



Gods normally have all nine of the great chakra, although there are occasional exceptions. This is why even the greatest of gods may not have more than nine spheres and rarely more than seven since the Kihadhara and Bindhudharma Chakra are inactive (or more accurately, enveloped) when the character is in the related deeper astral realm.

Spirits may have various combinations of Chakra, but usually have all nine when active within the material plane. Elemental beings usually have substantial weakness associated with opposing elemental chakra.

Magical theorists note a correspondence between the six higher chakra and Theurgy's six magical verbs: Svadhisthana/Transform, Manipura/Destroy, Anahata/Control, Sahasrara/Heal, Visshudha/Create, and Ajna/Perceive. A true master of the chakra should - at least theoretically - be able to draw vast power from the upper astral thru the Kihadhara chakra, focus and transform it through the seven basic chakra and release it into the world through the Bindudharma chakra. Unfortunately, or perhaps fortunately, such a transcendent Kundalini state "risks" (offers?) true unity with the higher realms and the consequent inability to return to the normal world.

For reference purposes the following feats usually require bonding to one of the user's Chakra: Blessing, Companion (when mystically linked to the owner), Domain/Path (other than those provided by another entity), certain variants of Eldritch, Innate Enchantment (Absorption), Invocation (unless accomplished by calling

on an entity which consciously decides whether or not to respond), Karma (at GMO), Mystic Link (Spell/Power links and up), Dominion/Godfire, Rite of C'hi (if taken with bonus uses), Channeling, and the Dragon Path (Eye or Pulse of the Dragon). Thus, each of these abilities (but not necessarily individual feats) takes up an available slot. Shamanism, Lycanthropy, and Priestcraft usually require one as well. Thus, characters have some limits on the special powers they may take, even in the wildest games.



Theoretically, one might be able to eliminate Chakra bindings and free them up again (also freeing up the CP spent on those abilities). No, we don't have a specific way to do this. It would take a lot of power, access to the most puissant lore, and a lot of finesse to accomplish. A greater, nearly transcendent being might be able to do it for someone else, and some forms of

personal transformation might succeed. For an example of the latter, it might be possible for a deity to leave behind the immortal power of the spheres to a successor and live out a quiet life somewhere else.